



Competency-Based Medical Education (CBME) Pilot for International Medical Graduates (IMGs): A New Model for Board Eligibility

Meredith Kleiber
Credentialist, Academic Affairs

Disclosure

Meredith Kleiber – Credentialist, ABIM Department of Academic Affairs

- To protect the integrity of certification, ABIM enforces strict confidentiality and ownership of exam content.
- As members of the ABIM staff, we agree to keep exam information confidential.
- ***No exam questions will be disclosed in our presentation.***

ABIM Pilot Pathway to Board Eligibility for Exceptionally Qualified International Medical Graduates (IMGs)

ACGME-I
Residency or
ACGME IMG
Exceptionally
Qualified
Candidates



ACGME-
Accredited
Fellowship
Training



Eligible for IM
Certification



Pass the IM Exam



Eligible for
Subspecialty
Certification



American Board
of Medical Specialties

Higher standards. Better care.®

Pilot Eligibility

- Eligibility is **prospective and retroactive**
 - Begins with IMGs who began ACGME-accredited fellowship training July 1, 2016, and after
 - Corresponds with establishment of “exceptionally qualified” criteria and pathway by ACGME
 - Requires successful completion of accredited fellowship training to become IM Board Eligible via the Pilot



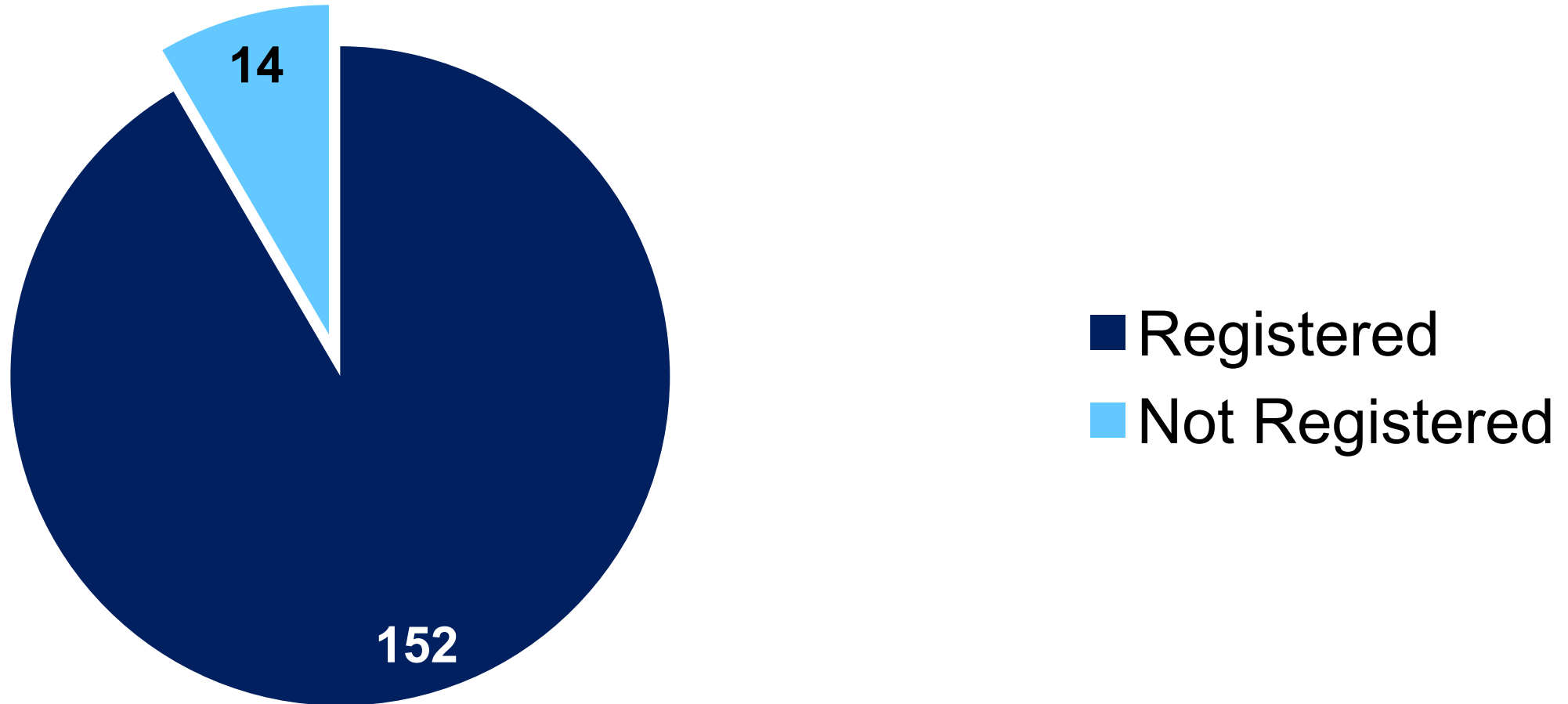
Criteria for Eligible Candidates

- Completion of **three years of verified GME training in internal medicine** abroad (outside of the U.S. or Canada)
- Met the **ACGME criteria to be considered an “exceptionally qualified candidate”** or entered fellowship as a graduate of an ACGME-International program
- Satisfactorily completed **training** in an ACGME-accredited fellowship, which has been **attested to by the program director in ABIM’s FasTrack Clinical Competence Evaluation System**
- Hold a valid Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduates (ECFMG) certificate
- Hold a **valid, unrestricted, and unchallenged clinical license** to practice medicine

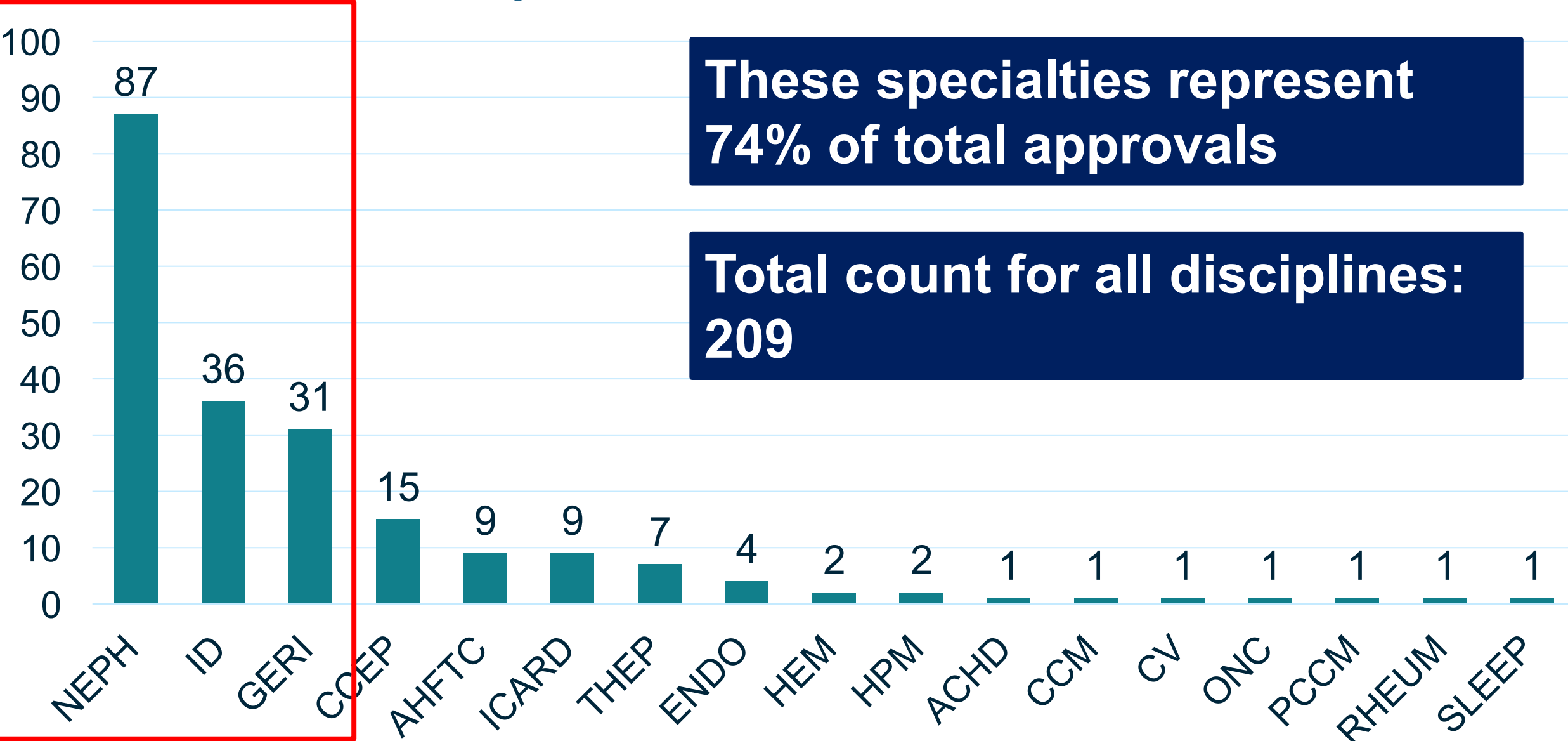
Pilot Outcomes Data: A 12-Month Snapshot

- Data collected: **September 2025–September 2026**
- Number of approved applications: **209**
- Application approval rate: **96%**
- Registered for 2026 Internal Medicine Exam: **92%** of the 166 applicants approved before reg closed in April 2026
- Pass rates will become available after the 2026 IM exam administration period (October 22, 2026)

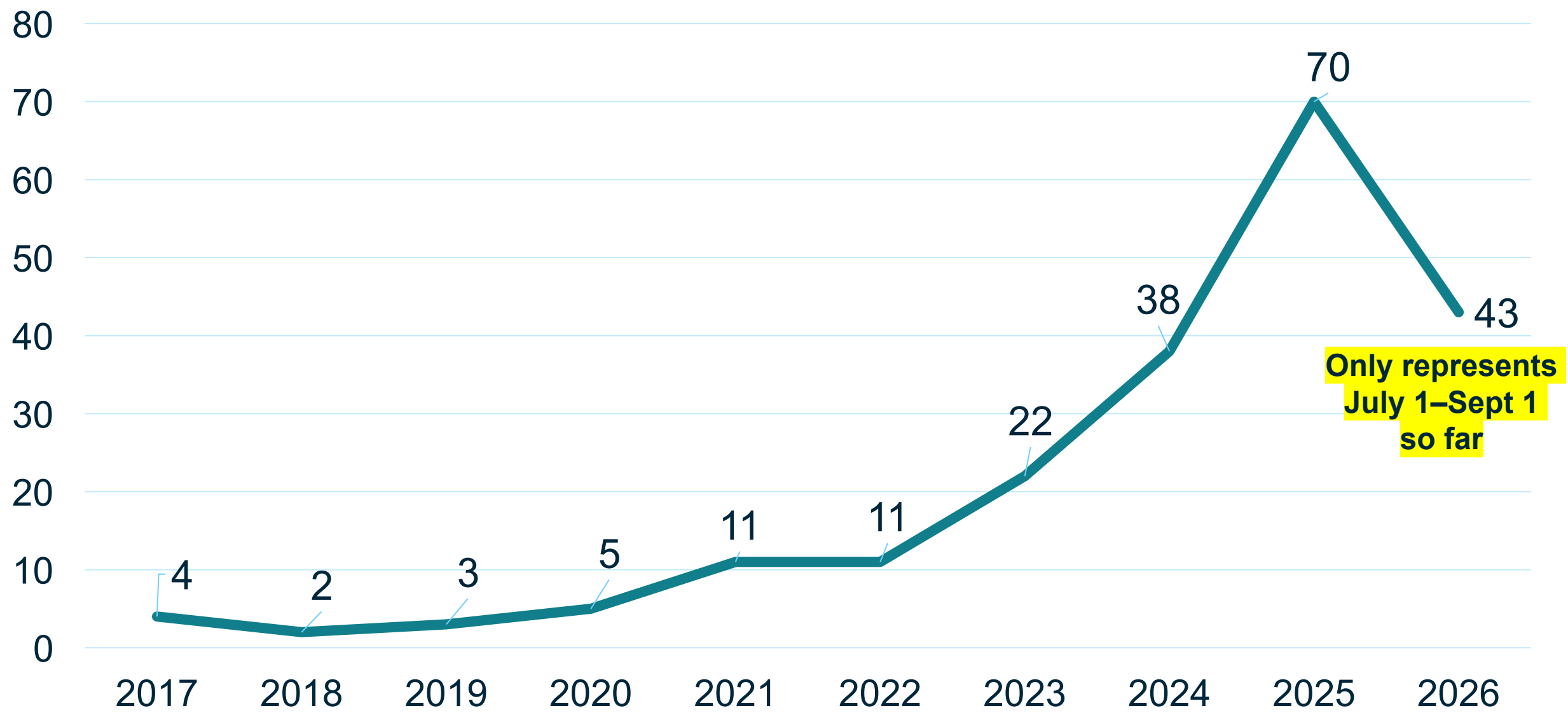
92% of Those Approved for the Pathway Prior to 2026 Exam Registration Deadline have Registered for Exam



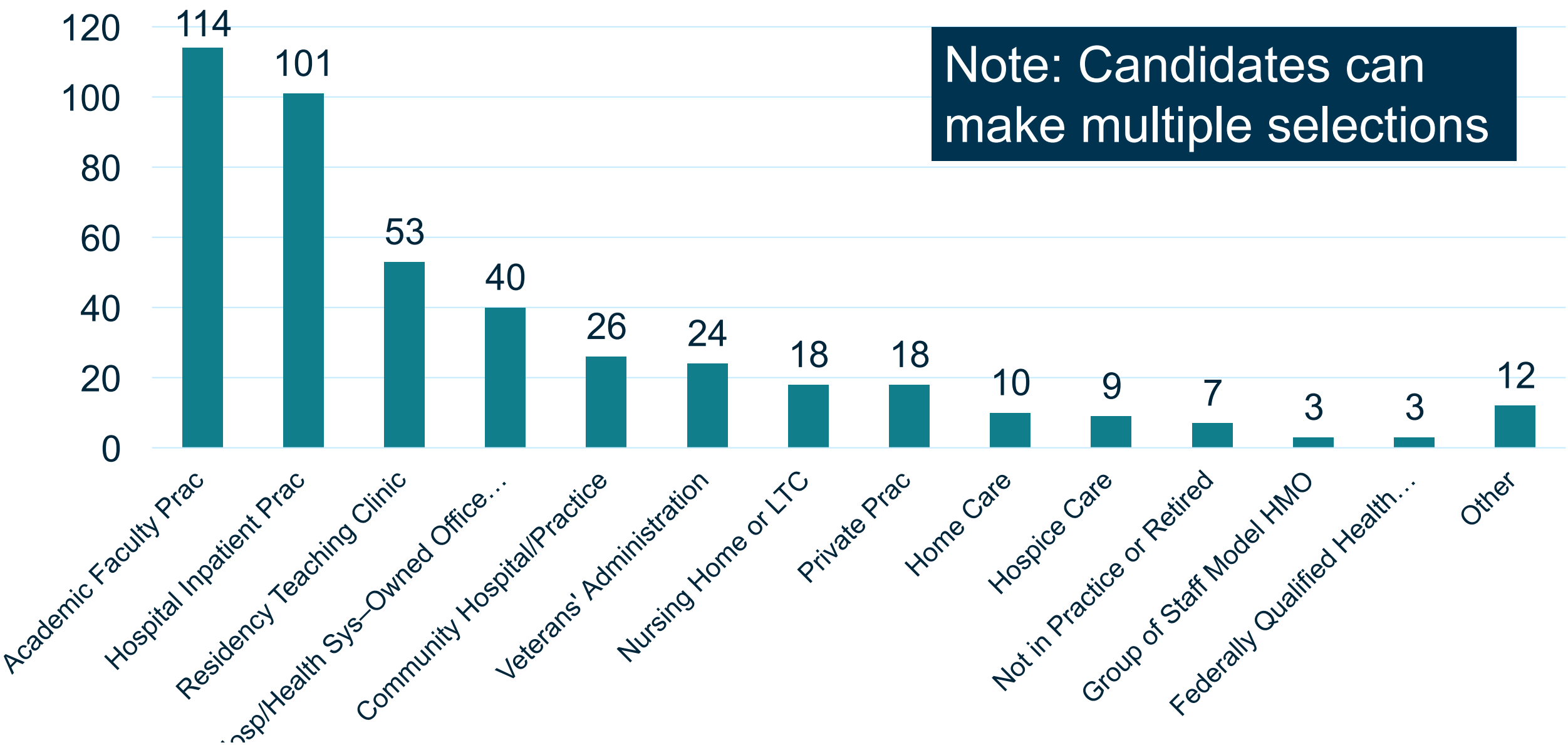
Number of Approved CBME Pilot Applicants by Specialty Since Implementation in September 2025



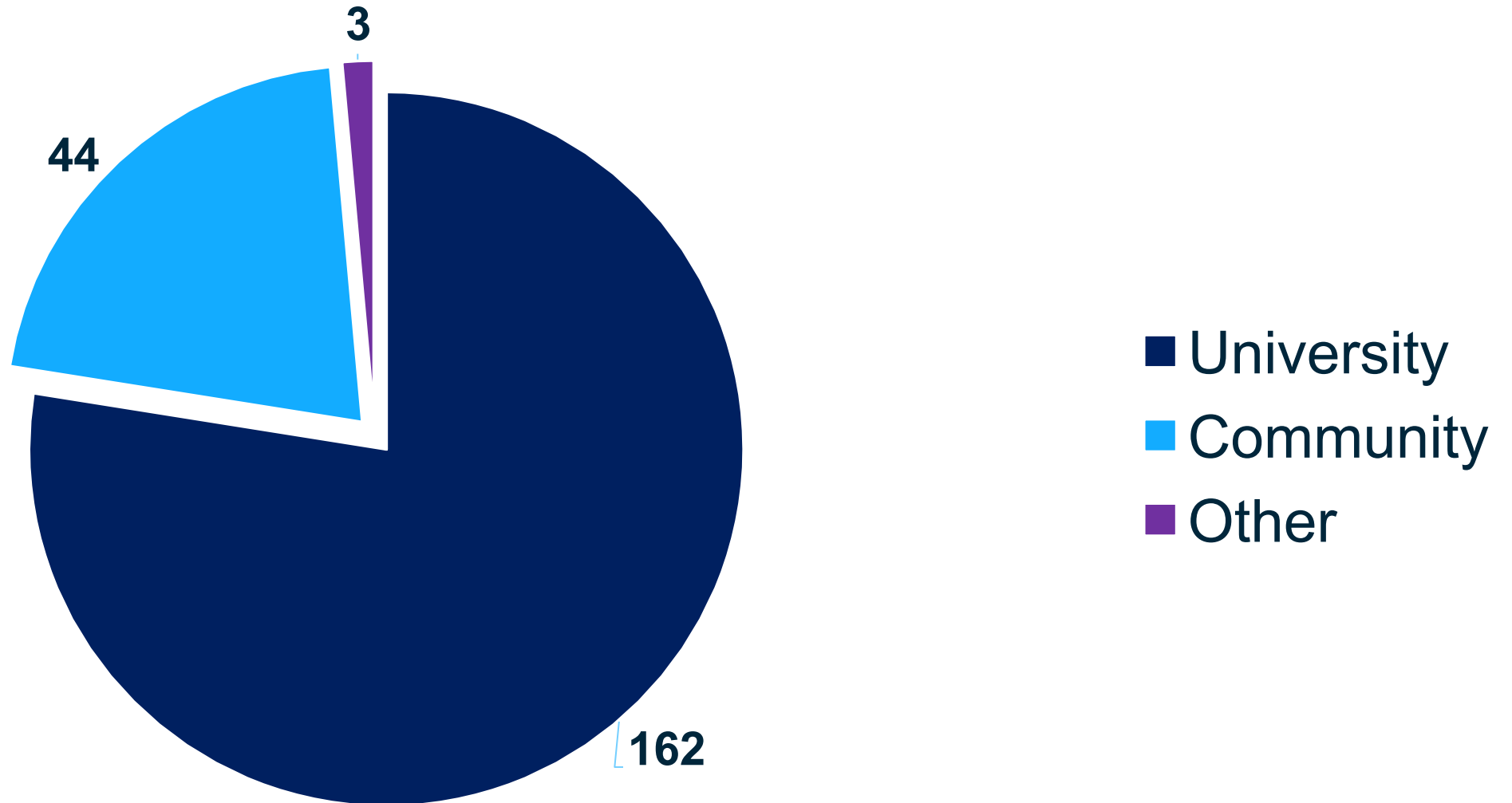
Fellowship Graduation Year of Approved CBME Pilot Applicants



Types of Practice of Approved Applicants

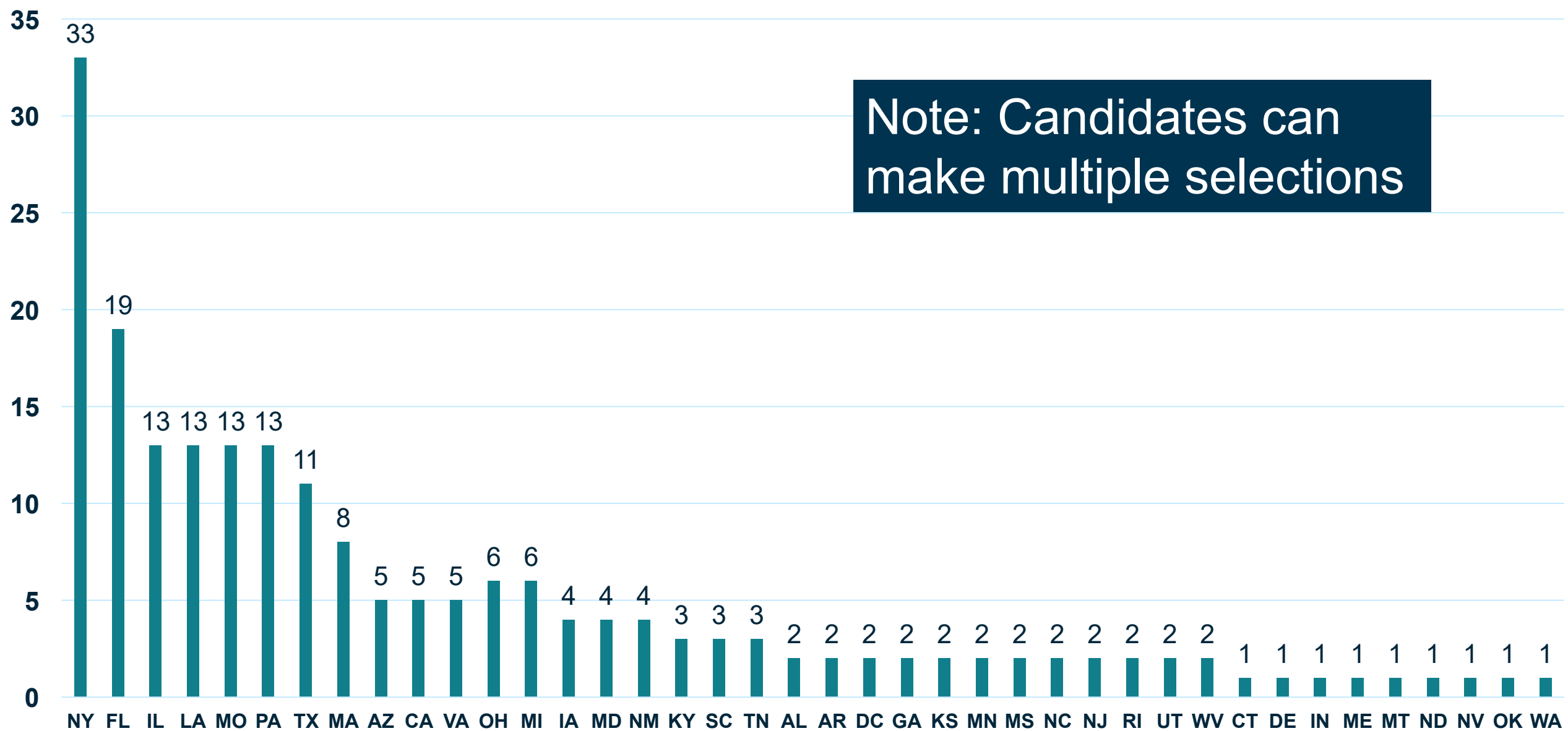


Type of Training Program of Approved Applicants



Practice Location of Approved Applicants

Note: Candidates can make multiple selections



Pilot Duration and Outcomes

- ABIM will initially offer Pilot for a minimum of **5 years**
 - Corresponds with the longest duration of fellowship training (e.g., 3-year cardiovascular disease and 2-year adult congenital heart disease)
- Council to **follow metrics throughout** initial duration, then decide:
 - Is the Pilot meeting its *objectives and outcomes*?
 - Are there *additional questions* the Pilot might answer?
 - Should the Pilot *continue beyond* minimum duration?



Thank you!

Questions, Comments?

Email: academicaffairs@abim.org



510 Walnut Street, Suite 1700, Philadelphia, PA 19106 | abim.org